NCCP 00209 · VERSION 10A

Modified FOLFOX-6

Day 1: oxaliplatin, folinic acid and fluorouracil, followed by a 46-hour fluorouracil pump. A cycle lasts 14 days.

Draft for clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review. Selected effects; not a complete medicine leaflet.

A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.

1 Mouth

Fluorouracil + folinic acid

Painful mouth or ulcers affecting eating or drinking need advice.

2 Throat / breathing

Oxaliplatin

Cold may trigger throat sensations. New breathing difficulty needs assessment.

3 Chest

Fluorouracil

New chest pain needs urgent assessment, including during the pump infusion.

4 Bowel

Fluorouracil + folinic acid

Report diarrhoea, increased stoma output, severe pain or dehydration.

5 Nerves

Oxaliplatin

Cold-triggered tingling or numbness. Report difficulty with buttons or walking.

6 Hands / feet

Fluorouracil

Red, tender or peeling palms or soles can need treatment changes.

7 Blood / infection

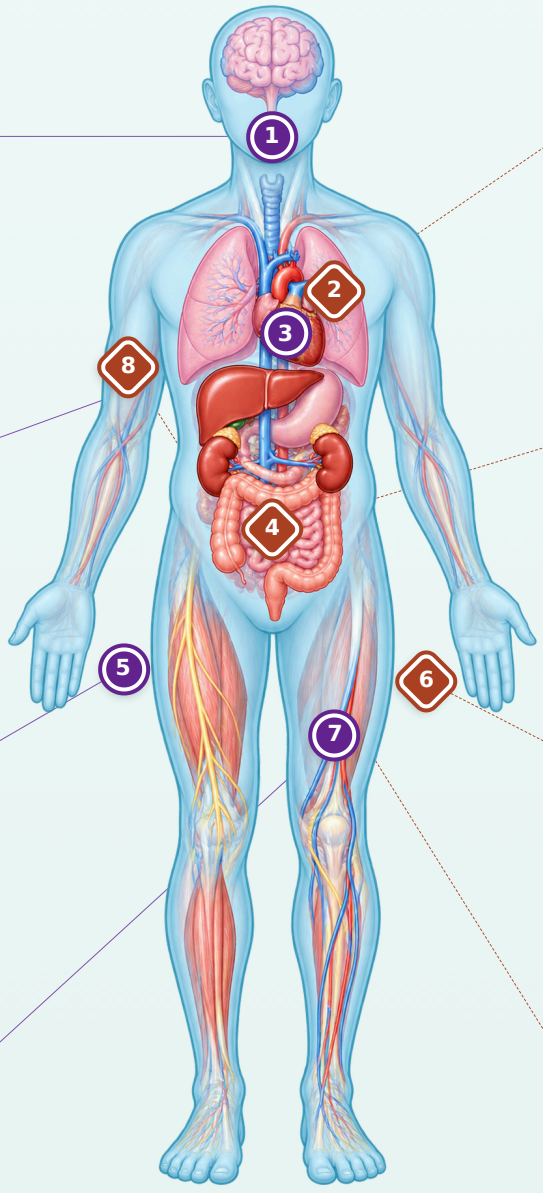
Oxaliplatin + fluorouracil

Fever, shivers or sudden illness: contact oncology immediately.

8 Pump / line

Fluorouracil delivery

Leakage, swelling, pain or a disconnected line needs immediate advice.



Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: contact oncology immediately. Severe chest pain, breathing difficulty, collapse or seizure: 112 / 999.

NCCP 00209 · PRACTICAL SUPPORT

Your treatment, at home.

Important medicine-specific effects

Oxaliplatin

- Cold-triggered tingling / throat discomfort
- Persistent sensory neuropathy, sometimes lasting after treatment
- Allergic / infusion reaction
- Low blood counts and infection
- Nausea, diarrhoea and fatigue
- Rare serious lung or blood complications

Folinic acid

- Enhances fluorouracil activity and toxicity
- Rare allergic reaction
- Diarrhoea / mouth soreness in combination

Fluorouracil

- Diarrhoea, dehydration and mouth ulcers
- Low blood counts / infection
- Hand-foot skin soreness
- Cardiotoxicity including chest pain / ischaemia
- Severe early toxicity including DPD-related toxicity
- Pump / central-line complications

Make the plan practical

DPD testing before fluorouracil

DPD helps the body break down fluorouracil. Deficiency can cause severe toxicity. Testing guides the plan but cannot exclude all serious reactions; unexpectedly severe early diarrhoea, mouth sores or illness needs immediate review.

Cold precautions

Oxaliplatin can trigger cold-related nerve symptoms. Avoid cold drinks and direct cold exposure if advised. Do not use ice chips during this regimen. Throat tightness or breathing difficulty needs assessment; do not assume it is harmless cold sensitivity.

Pump and line care

Check the pump and line as taught. Keep the disconnection appointment and written spill instructions. Pain, swelling, redness, leakage, a wet dressing or a change in pump delivery needs contact with the team.

Anti-sickness support

Take prescribed preventive medicines and keep the breakthrough plan available. Some anti-sickness medicines cause constipation. Ask for review if symptoms are poorly controlled.

Emergency: 112 / 999. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

Contact oncology immediately for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital's instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

Local · MON–FRI 8AM–5PM

Insert numbers here

Acute Oncology Service

Local · WEEKENDS / BANK HOLIDAYS 9AM–5PM

Insert numbers here

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

Complete reference, visual timeline and passport

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00209/

Sources and review status are available online. Follow your own prescription and hospital instructions.